STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-3441
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED **06/01/06**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT RESIDENTIAL ALARMS	CROSS REFERENCE P-3460 DOMESTIC VIOLENCE P-4220 BUILDING SEARCHES P-5000 HIGH RISK INCIDENTS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for responding to residential alarm calls.

II. Policy:

There are a variety of residential alarms including: intrusion alarms, panic/medical alarms, and domestic violence alarms. Each type of alarm requires different response techniques. Deputies must remain vigilant when responding to alarms and not become complacent due to the vast number of false alarms.

III. Procedures:

A. Residential Intrusion Alarms-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. The initial responding deputy may check the exterior of the residence prior to the arrival of the second deputy, and he or she may cancel the back-up unit if the residence appears secure.

2. If an exterior door is found to be unsecured or other entry appears to have been made (e.g. a broken window), the residence shall be searched (see P-4220 Building Searches). If deputies search a residence as a result of an alarm call the following procedures shall apply:

a) A business card shall be left in plain view with a notation on the back regarding the deputies' search of the residence and the time of the alarm call.

b) The residence should be secured, if possible.

3. If the residence is secure, Communications shall be notified.

4. Communications shall provide representative information. The initial responding deputy may remain on location for the representative if his or her arrival is expected within a reasonable amount of time.

5. If an individual is encountered at the residence and the individual claims to either be a resident or have permission to be on location, the deputy shall identify the individual, run a records check on the party, and verify the individual's claim with Communications.

B. **Residential Panic/Medical Alarm- Deputy Responsibilities:** Generally, these alarms must be activated with the alarm keypad or with a remote device.

1. Because of the possible threat to life related to this type of alarm activation, deputies shall generally respond urgent status to this type of alarm call.

2. Deputies should use caution when approaching the scene of a panic alarm. The alarm could have been activated as a result of a crime in progress.

C. **Domestic Violence Alarm-Deputy Responsibilities:** Domestic violence alarms are provided to victims of domestic violence crimes who believe they may continue to be victimized. The system is installed free of charge and consists of a monitor box and remote activation button that is carried by the individual. The Sheriff's Office Road Patrol Division shall be notified of any domestic violence alarms activated within the Sheriff's Office's jurisdiction. This notification shall be made by a domestic violence advocate or the Victim Witness Unit. Deputies receiving a domestic violence alarm shall adhere to the following procedures:

1. Deputies shall respond urgent status.

2. Deputies shall use due caution when approaching the residence and follow domestic violence call guidelines (P-3460 Domestic Violence).

3. If the residence appears secure, the deputies shall have Communications contact the alarm company and locate an emergency contact number for the individual.

4. Deputies **must** have contact with the individual prior to going in-service. If the individual is at the residence, the deputies must have

face-to-face contact with the party. If the party is not on location, the deputies may have contact over the phone.

5. Deputies shall determine the cause of the alarm activation.

6. If deputies believe individuals are at the residence but are refusing to answer the door or the telephone, deputies shall notify their supervisor and follow the high risk incident procedures (see P-5000 High Risk Incidents).